

WHY RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT?

BROWN DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO TECHNICIAN
BLUE DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE

TEXT: Ephesians 5:15-20 (KJV) *"See then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise, 16 Redeeming the time, because the days are evil. 17 Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is. 18 And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit; 19 Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord; 20 Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."*

INTRO: Most people, who call themselves Christian, believe in the person of the Holy Spirit, at least in some limited dimension. The extent of these beliefs has made for many interesting conversations as well as quite a large number of heated religious debates.

Following conversion, those who have received the infilling of the Holy Spirit as a second definite work of grace are widely known as Pentecostal or Charismatic.

It is estimated that Pentecostals/Charasmatrics world-wide number more that 500,000,000!

To begin with, I want to point out what I believe to be several general Scriptural facts concerning the person

of the Holy Spirit: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The Holy Spirit is the third person of the Holy trinity
- The Holy Spirit works in unity with the Father and the Son
- The Holy Spirit is the power behind the implementation of Gods purpose in the earth

In order to fully understand the subject matter I want to attempt to answer the following questions: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Is the baptism in the Holy Spirit for all believers? Acts 2:38-40 (NKJV) *"Then Peter said to them, "Repent, and let every one of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins; and you shall receive the gift of the Holy Spirit."³⁹ "For the promise is to you and to your children, and to all who are afar off, as many as the Lord our God will call."*
- Does a believer receive the Holy Spirit at conversion? Acts 19:1-7 (NKJV) *"And it happened, while Apollos was at Corinth, that Paul, having passed through the upper regions, came to Ephesus. And finding some disciples² he said to them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?" So they said to him, "We have not so much as heard whether there is a Holy Spirit."³ And he said to them, "Into what then were you baptized?" So they said, "Into John's baptism."⁴ Then Paul said, "John indeed baptized with a baptism of repentance, saying to the people*

that they should believe on Him who would come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus.”⁵ When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.⁶ And when Paul had laid hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke with tongues and prophesied.⁷ Now the men were about twelve in all.” All believers receive the seal of the Holy Spirit at conversion. The baptism in the Holy Spirit is a second work of grace, subsequent to the work of salvation.

- **To receive the Holy Spirit, is it necessary to speak in tongues?** To adequately answer this question, I want us to look at each time groups of people or individuals received the Holy Spirit in the book of Acts: **(1) Acts 2:1-4 (KJV)** *“And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. 2 And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. 3 And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. 4 And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.”* We must conclude that in this initial outpouring, each of the 120 did in fact speak in tongues. **(2) Acts 8:14-18 (KJV)** *“Now when the apostles which were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent unto them Peter and John: 15 Who, when they were come down, prayed for them, that they might receive the Holy Ghost:*

16 (For as yet he was fallen upon none of them: only they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.) 17 Then laid they their hands on them, and they received the Holy Ghost. 18 And when Simon saw that through laying on of the apostles' hands the Holy Ghost was given, he offered them money." This Scripture

does not say that they spoke in tongues, but there was some kind of visible sign of the outpouring of the Spirit, because even Simon recognized what had happened. (3) Acts 9:17-18 (KJV) *"And Ananias went his way, and entered into the house; and putting his hands on him said, Brother Saul, the Lord, even Jesus, that appeared unto thee in the way as thou camest, hath sent me, that thou mightest receive thy sight, and be filled with the Holy Ghost. 18 And immediately there fell from his eyes as it had been scales: and he received sight forthwith, and arose, and was baptized."*

This outpouring of the Spirit upon Saul, who would later become Paul does not reference the fact that he spoke in tongues but listen to what Paul say's at a later time. 1 Corinthians 14:18 (NKJV) *"I thank my God I speak with tongues more than you all."* (4) Acts 10:44-46 (NKJV) *"While Peter was still speaking these words, the Holy Spirit fell upon all those who heard the word.45 And those of the circumcision who believed were astonished, as many as came with Peter, because the gift of the Holy Spirit had been poured out on the Gentiles also.46 For they heard them speak with tongues and*

magnify God..." This is the account of the outpouring of the Holy Spirit upon the house of Cornelius, who was a gentile. The Gentiles did speak in tongues when they were filled with the Spirit. (5) Acts 19:1-6 (NKJV) ***"And it happened, while Apollos was at Corinth, that Paul, having passed through the upper regions, came to Ephesus. And finding some disciples 2 he said to them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?" So they said to him, "We have not so much as heard whether there is a Holy Spirit."3 And he said to them, "Into what then were you baptized?" So they said, "Into John's baptism."4 Then Paul said, "John indeed baptized with a baptism of repentance, saying to the people that they should believe on Him who would come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus."5 When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.6 And when Paul had laid hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke with tongues and prophesied."***

- **Why was tongues chosen as the initial physical evidence of Holy Spirit Baptism?** The tongue is the most unruly member of the body. James 3:6-8 (NKJV) ***"And the tongue is a fire, a world of iniquity. The tongue is so set among our members that it defiles the whole body, and sets on fire the course of nature; and it is set on fire by hell.***7 For every kind of beast and bird, of reptile and creature of the sea, is tamed and has been tamed by mankind.8 But no man

can tame the tongue. It is an unruly evil, full of deadly poison."

Before we decide to write the Holy Spirit off as unimportant or insignificant we should consider the words of Jesus as it relates to the importance of the Holy Spirit. John 16:7 (KJV) ***"Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you."***

In this Scripture, Jesus is stressing to His disciples the necessity of His departure. As long as He lived in a flesh and blood body He could only be in one place at a time. He is attempting to explain to them that the reason it was so necessary for Him to go to the Father was so that the Holy Spirit would come and live in each believer, thus empowering each believer to carry on the work of Christ in the world. If Jesus thought it necessary to depart so that the Holy Spirit could indwell and empower believers, where do we get off promoting the Holy Spirit as optional equipment?

I want us to look at seven Scriptural reasons for being filled with the Spirit...

I. WE SHOULD RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT BECAUSE WE HAVE BEEN COMMANDED TO DO SO!

No doubt, every believer would agree that to disobey one of the Ten Commandments would be to sin. What I am about to say will more than likely be viewed as a very narrow interpretation of Scripture. I believe all disobedience is sin.

We are commanded in Scripture to be filled with the Spirit. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** Paul said to the Ephesians *"And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;"* (Eph. 5:18)

Listen to what Jesus has to say on the subject! Luke 24:49 (NKJV) ***"Behold, I send the Promise of My Father upon you; but tarry in the city of Jerusalem until you are endued with power from on high."***

Jesus deemed the infilling of the Holy Spirit so significant in the lives of the first century Apostles that He demanded they place their lives and schedules on hold to join in a ten day prayer meeting! The people Jesus is speaking to here were busy people! They were not unemployed and sitting around hoping someone would assign them a responsibility for ten days and nights! At the conclusion of this ten day prayer meeting they received the infilling of the Holy Spirit! Acts 2:1-4 (NKJV) ***"And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. 2 And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. 3 And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. 4 And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance."***

The reason Jesus commanded these busy people to spend ten days in a prayer meeting is because He knew they were going to need the power the Holy Spirit

could furnish! Jesus looked down the road ahead of the first century disciples to a day when they would need power for life and service! The same thing applies to all of us twenty one centuries later!

(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) Someone asked, *"Must I be filled with the Holy Spirit to go to Heaven?"* My answer, *"I would not want to go to the post office without the Holy Spirit!"*

God never commands us to do anything simply for the spiritual exercise! When He gives us a command there are always a host of reasons behind His commands!

We should receive the Holy Spirit because we have been commanded to do so!

II. WE SHOULD RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT BECAUSE HE HAS BEEN APPOINTED AS OUR TEACHER!

In our lifetime all of us have had many teachers. Very few of us recall specific profound lessons our teachers taught us but we do remember the lessons they taught us through the relationships they built with us!

Teachers oftentimes become mentors to their students! Jesus tells us that by design, the Holy Spirit is to become the instructor of each believer! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** John 14:26 (NKJV) ***"But the Helper, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in My name, He will teach you all things, and bring to your remembrance all things that I said to you."***

When we receive the infilling of the Holy Spirit we receive a heightened awareness of the will of God, as well as a heightened sensitivity to the voice of the Holy Spirit.

When a person has received the infilling of the Holy Spirit, this teacher opens the Word of God as never before! The truths of God's Word seem to come alive to the believer!

Because this teacher lives within us, He is able to bring back to our remembrance the Word of God at a moment's notice! This teacher speaks to us from within, when we are doing right, and when we are doing wrong!

The closer the relationship we develop with the teacher, the more we are capable of learning!

(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) It is not the responsibility of the mentor to make time for the disciple; it is the responsibility of the disciple to carve out time to spend at the feet of the mentor! The more shallow the relationships with the teacher, the less we are capable of learning! We are as close to Him as we want to be!

We should receive the Holy Spirit to receive Godly instruction!

III. WE SHOULD RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT BECAUSE HE HAS BEEN APPOINTED AS OUR GUIDE!

A guide is defined as one who knows the way, usually because they have already been there. If I am going to follow a guide, I want to know that they know what they are doing and where they are going! (My experience in a helicopter at Mt. Rushmore)

There is a terrific difference between a pioneer and a guide. A pioneer is blazing a trail in hopes of developing a path for others to follow. A guide is one who already knows the way and leads those who are less knowledgeable along the path. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

John 16:12-15 (NKJV) ***"I still have many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now."***¹³ ***"However, when He, the Spirit of truth, has come, He will guide you into all truth; for He will not speak on His own authority, but whatever He hears He will speak; and He will tell you things to come."***¹⁴ ***"He will glorify Me, for He will take of what is Mine and declare it to you."***¹⁵ ***"All things that the Father has are Mine. Therefore I said that He will take of Mine and declare it to you."***

The work of the Holy Spirit in the life of the believer is that of revelation. He has no agenda of His own; He is simply a guide who discovers what the Father desires in our lives and reveals the path of travel to each believer.

A portion of the work of the Holy Spirit consists of revealing the will of God for ministry to each believer! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** Acts 13:2-4 (NKJV) ***"As they ministered to***

the Lord and fasted, the Holy Spirit said, “Now separate to Me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them.”³ Then, having fasted and prayed, and laid hands on them, they sent them away. 4 So, being sent out by the Holy Spirit, they went down to Seleucia, and from there they sailed to Cyprus.”

There is an old song that say's "*The Lord knows the way through the wilderness, all I have to do is follow.*"

If the Lord knows the way, which He does; He then reveals it to the Holy Spirit; who in turn reveals it to the believer.

The Holy Spirit is our guide we must follow His instructions implicitly!

We should receive the Holy Spirit because He can reveal the path of life!

IV. WE SHOULD RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT BECAUSE HE EMPOWERS US FOR SERVICE!

It is my opinion that all who have received Jesus as Lord and Savior will have a desire to serve Him and others. In the Old Testament the priest would anoint his right ear, right thumb and right great toe. This symbolized: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Having the mind of Christ...
- Doing the work of Christ...
- Walking the walk of Christ...

The three things every believer must do in order to please God is to: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Have the mind of Christ!
- Do the work of Christ!
- Walk the walk of Christ!

Serving strictly from duty or obligation runs a little thin pretty quick. If we are to serve effectively over the long haul of our Christian lives we must operate in the power of the Spirit, rather than functioning within our own abilities! Acts 1:8 (NKJV) **“But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.”**

Some people think they can do the work of God through their own ability! This is impossible over the long haul! Jesus needed the empowerment of the Holy Spirit to do what He was able to do! Acts 10:38 (NKJV) **“How God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power, who went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with Him.”**

The Apostle Paul was aware of his need for the anointing and empowerment of the Holy Spirit to do the work of God. 2 Corinthians 3:2-6 (NKJV) **“You are our epistle written in our hearts, known and read by all men; 3 clearly you are an epistle of Christ, ministered by us, written not with ink but by the Spirit of the living God, not on tablets of stone but on tablets of flesh, that is, of the heart. 4 And we have such trust through Christ toward God. 5 Not that we are sufficient of ourselves to think of anything as**

being from ourselves, but our sufficiency is from God,6 who also made us sufficient as ministers of the new covenant, not of the letter but of the Spirit; for the letter kills, but the Spirit gives life."

If Jesus and Paul needed the empowerment of the Holy Spirit, we will surely need His help! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

We should receive the Holy Spirit to be empowered for service!

V. WE SHOULD RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT BECAUSE HE WILL PRAY THROUGH US WHEN WE DO NOT KNOW WHAT TO PRAY FOR!

One of the works of the Holy Spirit in the life of the believer is to enhance and make more effective his or her prayer life. Romans 8:26-27 (NKJV) *"Likewise the Spirit also helps in our weaknesses. For we do not know what we should pray for as we ought, but the Spirit Himself makes intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered.27 Now He who searches the hearts knows what the mind of the Spirit is, because He makes intercession for the saints according to the will of God."*

Think of this: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- When we do not know what to pray for, the Holy Spirit knows exactly what to pray for!
- When we do not know how to pray because we do not know what the will of the Father is, the

Holy Spirit is never in question about the will of God!

- When we have exhausted our vocabulary, the Spirit has not exhausted His!

The Holy Spirit anoints us to pray in two very distinct ways: 1 Corinthians 14:15 (NKJV) *"I will pray with the spirit, and I will also pray with the understanding. I will sing with the spirit, and I will also sing with the understanding."* **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- In the Spirit - In Tongues!
- In the Spirit - In our native language! (Being asked to pray in the Arkansas Governors mansion) (Praying over a house where some strange activity had been going on)

I am sure all of us have felt at times that our prayer life was somewhat deficient and inadequate. The Holy Spirit has been appointed to be our helper in prayer. What we lack, He makes up for. The most effective praying is Holy Spirit anointed praying!

We should receive the Holy Spirit and allow Him to pray through us!

VI. WE SHOULD RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT BECAUSE HE IS TO BE OUR COMFORTER!

John 15:26 (KJV) *"But when the Comforter is come, whom I will send unto you from the Father, even the Spirit of truth, which proceedeth from the Father, he shall testify of me:"*

On numerous occasions in the Bible, the Holy Spirit is referred to as the comforter. Because of the times we are living in, when we use the word comforter, all kinds of images begin to manifest themselves, most of which do not lend themselves to a true assessment of what is being portrayed in Scripture. The image we come up with is probably a person who is weak and frail but willing to sympathize with our every need and concern. We might even visualize a weak frail person who is content to hang around a funeral home and cry with everyone who comes through the door.

When the Scripture uses the word comforter there is an attempt to say something far more significant.

The Greek word for Comforter is Paraklete which means: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- One called alongside for the purpose of assistance (Like a big brother)
- One who pleads another's cause before a judge (He is our legal representation)
- A counselor for the purpose of a defense (He is our defense lawyer when we stand accused) (Talk about pre-paid legal fees)
- A legal assistant (He researches all similar cases and furnishes the information to the judge)
- An intercessor (He is our most able advocate at Heavens court)
- A helper (Someone to assist in all situations)

Do you get the picture? The comforter is a constant abiding presence which is capable of assisting the believer in all situations!

Life can be extremely difficult not to mention complicated! All of us experience times in life when we need the help of others. Though some people attempt to isolate themselves, we are not engineered to deal with life's problems on our own! God said of Adam, Genesis 2:18, 21-23 (NKJV) ***"And the LORD God said, "It is not good that man should be alone; I will make him a helper comparable to him."***²¹ ***And the LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall on Adam, and he slept; and He took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place.***²² ***Then the rib which the LORD God had taken from man He made into a woman, and He brought her to the man.***²³ ***And Adam said: "This is now bone of my bones And flesh of my flesh; She shall be called Woman, Because she was taken out of Man."***

It is a wonderful thing to have family or friends who are closely enough connected that we feel free to enlist their help in difficult times. To walk through an extremely difficult time in life is bad enough, but to walk it out alone is even worse.

Why would anyone resist such help?

We should receive the Holy Spirit to access maximum assistance from the Heavenly Father!

VII. WE SHOULD RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT BECAUSE HE CONVICTS US OF SIN!

Most Christians would agree that a person cannot come to Christ apart from the conviction of the Holy Spirit. John 6:44 (NKJV) ***"No one can come to Me unless the Father who sent Me draws him..."*** How does the Father draw us? John 16:5-8 (LB) ***"But now I am going away to the one who sent me; and none of you seems interested in the purpose of my going; none wonders why. 6 Instead you are only filled with sorrow. 7 But the fact of the matter is that it is best for you that I go away, for if I don't, the Comforter won't come. If I do, he will—for I will send him to you. 8 "And when he has come he will convince the world of its sin, and of the availability of God's goodness, and of deliverance from judgment."*** A great portion of the work of the Holy Spirit is to make the unrepentant sinner fully aware of his hopeless eternal condition. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

Another aspect of the work of the Holy Spirit is to make Christians aware of their failures and sins! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** That's right, when we who are believers, fail, the Holy Spirit becomes the still small voice inside us which causes us to feel guilty concerning our sin. His purpose is not to make us feel like a failure but to bring us to repentance.

Listen to the importance of walking in the Spirit of God each day of our lives. Galatians 5:16 (NKJV) ***"I say then: Walk in the Spirit, and you shall not fulfill the lust of the flesh."*** Galatians 5:24-25 (NKJV) ***"And***

*those who are Christ's have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires.*²⁵ *If we live in the Spirit, let us also walk in the Spirit."*

If it is true that a portion of the work of the Holy Spirit is to help us walk out our life in Christ, why would we not want as much of the influence of the Spirit in our lives as possible?

Sometimes what the Word does not say is almost as important as what it does say. If it say's that "*If we walk in the Spirit we will not fulfill the lusts of the flesh*", then it also infers that "*If we do not walk in the Spirit we will fulfill the lusts of the flesh.*"

Those who have a passion to walk as close to Jesus as possible will eventually find the path to Holy Spirit baptism. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)** Once they step into this new dimension many things will change in their lives but one of the most significant changes will be the heightened awareness, of what pleases God and what does not.

We should receive the Holy Spirit to allow Him to convict us of our sin!